

Unmanned weapon

Britain's Ministry of Defence recently unveiled an unmanned stealth attack aircraft that chooses its own targets without human intervention

Blogs, kidnapped

A WordPress platform, less-known, Blogetery.com, used by more than 70,000 blog was recently shutdown by its hosting company, without any notification

Q&A

Slow connections, disappearing drives?

...Digit to the rescue

Computer network going haywire

I am a regular reader of Digit since June 2005. My friend's PC has been facing broadcasting problems on this network. In about 26 minutes of surfing the net, the total amount of sent data reaches about 2 lakh bytes and the data received reaches about 9 lakh. What kind of problem is this?

Tarun Goswami

It depends a lot on whether it is 9 lakh bytes or bits. Either way, PCs send and receive data all the time when connected to a network. If there are viruses on the network, your PC is bound to receive and send a lot of random data. There is nothing unusual about this. If you feel that the system is using up a lot of bandwidth, then install a firewall to try and figure which services and programs are using that bandwidth. Also, run an antivirus scan on your system to check for any threats.

Headphone microphone not working

I recently bought an Intex Mega headphone with mic (model no. HS-301B). I connected it to my PC and opened up Sound Recorder on Windows but the mic doesn't work. Then, I checked the headphones and they seemed to work fine. I went to the shop to exchange the piece with another one.

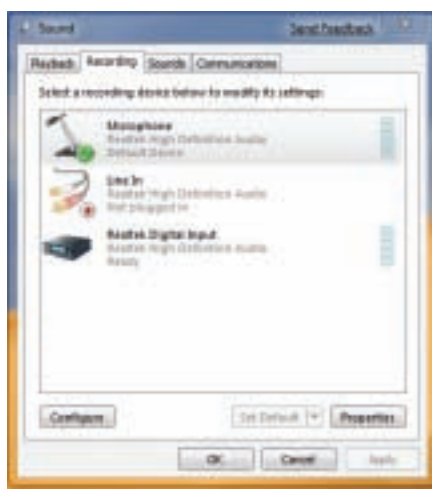
While giving me the new piece, the shop keeper said that if this piece doesn't work either, then my computer has a problem. I tried it but again, it didn't work. Then I tried it on another computer and to my surprise, it worked. Here are the configurations of the computer on which the mic doesn't work:

- Intel Pentium 4 CPU 2.66 GHz
- 504MB RAM
- Windows XP SP2
- Frontech Brisk CPU

I want to know why the microphone doesn't work and how to make it work.

Vinayak Nagri

You need to be very sure on which port you connect the microphone. Your drivers should alert you if the microphone is plugged into the wrong slot. Often, you'll need to specify the microphone input in your drivers or the Windows volume control panel. If you are using the front panel,



Window showing the proper connectivity with microphone

try the rear panels on your PC as well. The microphone volume might be set too or microphone boost disabled. Enable those settings and try again.

Prince of Persia framing

I bought this machine about a couple of months ago with the following configuration.



Selecting 'Microphone boost' to check the sound through speakers

- AMD Athlon X2 240 processor, 2800 MHz
- ASUS M2N68-AM SE2 motherboard
- NVIDIA GeForce 8400 GS, 512 MB graphics card
- ST3250318AS SCSI HDD

I feel my graphics card is not performing at its optimum level. When I run *Prince of Persia: Warrior Within* and the *Two thrones*. It shows the system configuration initially and the game shows the processor as "unknown AMD processor". The game runs, but is just not smooth. It runs well for a few seconds and then it starts stuttering. I need a remedy.

Prateek

The GeForce 8400GS is an extremely basic HTPC card and isn't designed for gaming as such. Upgrading to a card such as the GeForce 9800GT or the Radeon 5670 is recommended as they are better suited for the games you're trying to play.

Game trouble

1. I have recently purchased a copy of *Assassin's Creed II*, but it doesn't run after installation. It shows an error saying that an internet connection is required. Is there no way to run that game without internet connection? Please help me out to run the game?

2. I also have another game called *Crysis Warhead*. When I try to install this game, I see another error - "Cannot copy data2.cab: Data error(cyclic redundancy check)".

Surya Prakash Singh

Assassin's Creed II uses a DRM system that requires you to be connected to the internet while playing the game. As of now, there is no way of running it without the connection. The error while installing *Crysis Warhead* is due to a bad disc. You might have to get in touch with the game vendor to get you a replacement. There's also a chance your DVD drive maybe giving trouble. Check with some other discs to confirm this.